

GROWGRID DIGITAL

Digital Marketing Blueprint

Your Complete Reference Guide to Every Term That Matters

This blueprint is your go-to reference for the terminology that underpins every successful digital marketing campaign. Whether you're onboarding a new client, briefing your team, or planning your next growth sprint — keep this guide close. Organised into eight core disciplines, each entry cuts straight to what the term means and why it matters for GrowGrid Digital's work.

Search Engine Optimization (SEO)

Term	What It Means
SERP	Search Engine Results Page — the page shown after a user types a query into a search engine.
Keyword	A word or phrase that people type into search engines; targeting the right ones drives relevant traffic.
Backlink	A link from an external site pointing to yours — signals authority and boosts rankings.
Meta Tag	HTML snippet that tells search engines what a page is about (title, description, robots).
Anchor Text	The visible, clickable text of a hyperlink — influences how search engines understand the linked page.
Alt Text	Descriptive text attached to an image for accessibility and search engine context.
Crawling	How search engine bots discover and read pages across the web.
Indexing	Storing and organizing crawled pages so they can appear in search results.
Canonical URL	The definitive URL for a page when duplicate versions exist, preventing SEO dilution.
Organic Traffic	Visitors who land on your site through unpaid search results.



Analytics & Performance Metrics

Term	What It Means
KPI	Key Performance Indicator — a measurable value that shows how well a campaign is achieving its goals.
Conversion Rate	Percentage of visitors who complete a target action (purchase, signup, download).
ROI	Return on Investment — net profit divided by cost; the ultimate efficiency measure.
Bounce Rate	Share of visitors who leave after viewing just one page — high bounce often signals poor relevance.
Churn Rate	How quickly customers stop using your product or cancel subscriptions over a time period.
CLV	Customer Lifetime Value — total revenue expected from a single customer relationship.
Attribution	Assigning conversion credit to the right touchpoints along the customer journey.
Funnel	The step-by-step path a prospect takes from first awareness to final conversion.
Heatmap	A colour-coded visual showing where users click, scroll, or hover on a page.
Segmentation	Grouping your audience by shared traits to deliver more targeted, relevant messaging.



Core Digital Marketing Concepts

Term	What It Means
CTR	Click-Through Rate — clicks divided by impressions; shows how compelling your ad or link is.
CPM	Cost Per Mille — the price paid for every 1,000 ad impressions.
Landing Page	A standalone page built around a single campaign goal, designed to convert visitors.
Persona	A semi-fictional profile of your ideal customer used to shape messaging and targeting.
Lead Magnet	A free resource (guide, template, webinar) offered in exchange for contact information.
CTA	Call to Action — the prompt that tells your audience exactly what to do next.
A/B Testing	Running two versions of a page or ad simultaneously to find out which performs better.
Remarketing	Showing targeted ads to people who have already interacted with your brand online.
Lookalike Audience	A new audience built by a platform to mirror the characteristics of your best customers.
Marketing Automation	Using software to trigger personalised communications based on user behaviour or time.



Paid Advertising — Google Ads

Term	What It Means
PPC	Pay-Per-Click — the advertiser only pays when someone actually clicks the ad.
Impression	Each time an ad is displayed, regardless of whether it is clicked.
Quality Score	Google's 1–10 rating of keyword and ad relevance; higher scores lower your cost-per-click.
Ad Rank	The position your ad earns, calculated from your bid, Quality Score, and context.
CPC	Cost-Per-Click — the actual amount charged when a user clicks your ad.
Conversion Tracking	A snippet that records what users do after clicking — purchases, calls, form fills.
Ad Extension	Extra information added to an ad: sitelinks, call buttons, location, structured snippets.
Search Query	The exact text a user typed into Google that triggered your ad.
Display Network	Google's partner websites and apps where banner and visual ads can appear.
Smart Bidding	Automated bidding strategies (Target CPA, ROAS) that use machine learning to optimise bids.



Social Media Marketing

Term	What It Means
Engagement	Interactions — likes, comments, shares, saves — that show your audience is paying attention.
Influencer Marketing	Partnering with creators who have an engaged following to amplify your brand.
Social Listening	Monitoring platforms for mentions, keywords, and sentiment around your brand or industry.
Viral Content	Content that spreads rapidly because people feel compelled to share it.
Reach	The total number of unique accounts that see a piece of content.
UGC	User-Generated Content — posts, reviews, or videos created by your customers about your brand.
Story	Short-lived vertical content (images or video) that disappears after 24 hours.
Algorithm	The platform logic that decides which content gets shown to which users — and how often.
Carousel Post	A multi-image or multi-card format that users swipe through on feed.
Frequency	The average number of times one person sees your ad or post within a set period.

Term	What It Means
Open Rate	The percentage of recipients who open your email — a measure of subject line strength.
CTR (Email)	Click-Through Rate — how many openers actually clicked a link inside the email.
Hard Bounce	Permanent delivery failure, usually due to an invalid or non-existent address.
Soft Bounce	Temporary delivery failure (full inbox, server issue) that may resolve on retry.
Drip Campaign	A sequence of automated emails sent over time to guide leads toward a decision.
Autoresponder	An email triggered instantly by a subscriber action (signup, purchase, download).
List Hygiene	Regularly removing invalid, inactive, or unsubscribed contacts to protect deliverability.
Segmentation	Splitting your list into targeted groups so each audience receives relevant content.
Unsubscribe Rate	The percentage of recipients who opt out after a send — signals content-audience mismatch.
Sender Reputation	A score ISPs assign your domain/IP based on past sending behaviour; affects inbox placement.



Content Strategy & Copywriting

Term	What It Means
Evergreen Content	Content that stays relevant and valuable for months or years without constant updates.
SEO Copywriting	Writing that serves both human readers and search engines — informative and keyword-aware.
Headline	The first thing readers see; determines whether they read further or scroll past.
Keyword Density	How often a target keyword appears relative to total word count — balance is key.
Meta Description	The 150-160 character summary shown under your link in search results.
Whitepaper	An in-depth, authoritative document that explores a problem and offers expert guidance.
Content Calendar	A scheduled plan mapping out what content to publish, where, and when.
Pillar Page	A comprehensive page covering a broad topic that links out to in-depth cluster content.
Tone of Voice	The consistent personality and style a brand uses across all written communication.
Editorial Brief	A structured outline given to writers specifying goal, audience, keywords, and structure.



E-Commerce & Conversion

Term	What It Means
Cart Abandonment	When a shopper adds items to their cart but leaves before completing the purchase.
Upselling	Encouraging a buyer to choose a higher-value version or upgrade of the product they want.
Cross-selling	Recommending complementary products that pair well with what the customer is buying.
Payment Gateway	The secure online service that authorises and processes electronic payments.
Order Fulfilment	The end-to-end process of picking, packing, and shipping an order to the customer.
Return Rate	The percentage of purchased items that are sent back — an indicator of product-market fit.
Abandoned Cart Email	An automated follow-up sent to shoppers who left without checking out, nudging them to return.
Product Feed	A structured file (CSV/XML) listing product data used by Google Shopping, Meta Ads, etc.
Average Order Value	Total revenue divided by number of orders — lifted by upselling and bundling strategies.
Customer Reviews	Public ratings and feedback from buyers that build social proof and influence purchase decisions.